Imran Farhat, Pakistan's opening batsman and part-time leg-spinner. He blocked the first two balls before picking up two runs off the third ball. He once again blocked the fourth ball and was out to the fifth ball. Then, just as Parthiv Patel, the next batsman, started to come out, I saw Rahul gesturing us to go back to the pavilion. He had declared the innings with me stranded on 194 and with sixteen overs still left for the day, one more than we had agreed at tea. I was shocked, as it did not make any sense. It was day two of the Test match and not day four, as it had been in Sydney a month earlier.

Disappointed and upset, I made my way back to the dressing room and could sense that the whole team was surprised at the decision. Some of my team-mates perhaps expected me to throw my gear about in the dressing room in disgust and create a scene. However, such things are not in me and I decided not to say a word to anyone about the incident. I calmly put my batting gear away and asked John Wright for a little time before I went out to field because I was feeling a little tight after batting for so long. Inside I was fuming.

Just as I was washing my face in the bathroom, John walked up to me and apologized. He was sorry about what had happened and said he had not been party to the decision. I was surprised and said to him that as coach he was one of the decision-makers and there was no reason for him to be sorry if he believed in what had been done. I also said that what was done could not be reversed and it was best to leave it alone. Finally, I couldn't help reminding him that the declaration was contrary to what had been discussed at tea and it was strange that I was not given even one ball to get to my double hundred after a message had been sent out asking me to get there as quickly as possible.

Soon after my exchange with John, Sourav came up to me and said he was very sorry at what had happened and that it wasn't his decision to declare. This was a little surprising because Sourav, as the skipper, was part of the teatime discussion and was also present in the dressing room at the time of the declaration. I said to him there was no point going over it any more.

At the end of the day's play I was asked by the press if I was disappointed by the declaration and I had no reason to shy away from the truth. Soon after the press conference I put my headphones on and listened to music all the way back to the hotel. Then I hit the gym to work out my frustration. Some of the Pakistan players were also in the